

troubleshooting guide provided by the manufacture—this will have a list of the most common problems experienced. If all else fails, reinstall Windows.

Screen of death

Q, I use an ASUS motherboard with Athlon XP 1700+ processor, 256 MB of DDR RAM and run Windows 98 SE. The problem is that while loading Windows, after POST, the system shows a blue screen with the error: "A fatal exception OE has occurred at 017F: BFF8AB97. The current application will be terminated." When I restart the system again, Windows shows a message saying, "Windows did not shut down properly." Then the ScanDisk begins, after which Windows starts in the Safe mode.

Babu K

Via e-mail

A Whenever you install a new program, check if it is compatible with your existing OS. This problem generally occurs upon installation of a new program, which may have replaced some DLL files, resulting in the improper behaviour. Many of the programs freely distributed on the Net are not properly tested for bugs, causing your system to crash. In this case you have no choice but to uninstall the program from **Control Panel > Add/Remove Program**.

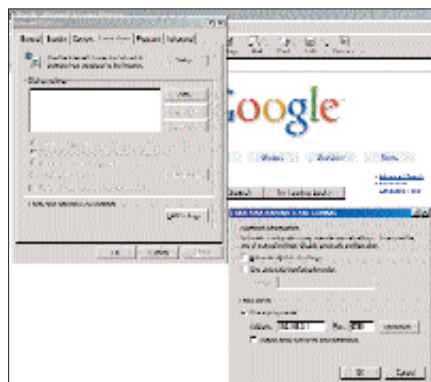
Internet sharing

Q, My problem is that I have five computers which are connected in a LAN. The operating system on all computers is Windows 98. Out of the five computers, one is connected to the Internet. I wish to extend the same connection to all other computers. How can I do this?

Sunil

Via e-mail

A To extend the same Net connection to



LAN Settings in Internet Options

Transfer problems

Q, I have two PCs—one at my house and the other at my office. I want to transfer a few of the Mp3s from my home PC to my office computer. I don't have a CD Writer, and want to transfer the files through the telephone line as it will be faster and cheaper than the File Transfer utility in the Instant Messenger. Please tell me the name of the software which can be used for this kind of dial-up transfer of files and the settings which will be needed.

Vikram S. Shah

Via e-mail

A The only software you need is Windows 98 with the Hyper Terminal installed. To check if your system has Hyper Terminal installed go to **Programs > Accessories > Communications**. If you don't find it here, go to **Control Panel > Add/Remove Program > Windows Setup >**

all your computers in a LAN, you need to make one machine a proxy server. This can be done by installing a software called AnalogX. The program is fairly easy to use, and involves minimal configuration.

After installing AnalogX, note down the IP address of the machine on which you have the Internet connection—this will be your proxy server. Now to gain Net access from each PC, go to **Tools > Internet Options > Connections > LAN Settings**. Click on 'Use a Proxy Server' and enter the IP address of the proxy server as the Address and 6588 as the Port. Now you can access the Internet through every machine you have configured. Just keep in mind that if you are using a dialup connection, the speed will be relatively slow as the bandwidth is shared by all your machines.

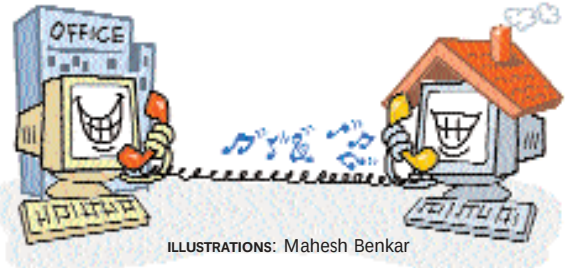
Slow burner

Q, I recently bought a 32x CD-Writer. My system is built on a Pentium III 667 MHz with 192 MB RAM. I have dual installation of Windows 98 and Windows XP. When I write a CD, I get a data write speed of 2 MB to 2.5 MB per second, whereas a 32x write speed should give me a transfer rate of 4800 KBps. I have tried using 32x and 40x CDR media disks.

Kunal

Via e-mail

Communications > Details. Here select Hyper Terminal and click OK to install it. Do this for both your computers. Set the Hyper Terminal on your office machine to 'Wait for a call'. To do this go to **Call > Wait for a call**. Now call the office machine from the house machine by going to **Call > Call**. Speci-



fy the Country Code, Area Code, Phone Number and Connect using then click OK.

Once the connection is set up, you will be able to transfer files from your house machine by clicking Send within the Transfer menu.

A There are a few things you can do to increase the data transfer rate—use a 80 pin conductor cable to connect the CD Writer to your PC. Next, run Disk Cleanup to free up more space on the hard drive. This will give the burning software more space for cache the files while writing the CDs. Finally, defragment your hard disk to speed up the read and write process, thus hurrying the data transfer rate.

Can I rollback my OS

Q, I have a Compaq Presario Pentium III 933 MHz with 128 MB RAM, running Windows Me that came pre-installed. I



The 80 pin conductor cable will hasten your transfer speeds